

St. Joseph's Church Wilton

Telephone: 021- 4341362 Website: www.smawilton.ie email: stjosephschurchwilton@sma.ie

32nd Sunday in Ordinary Time (Cycle A)

The parable of the 10 bridesmaids. The message of the parable is very clear: be ready for the coming of the Lord. This reminder about death and judgment is in keeping with the mood of November, the month of the departed. Nothing is more obvious about human life than the fact that everybody must die at some time. Yet our confused minds make us think and act as if we have the right to live on here forever. As secular thinking takes more of a grip in people's minds, death is becoming a taboo subject. The inevitability of death is not being honestly faced.

An old story about three devils goes: The first devil said: "Tell them there is no hell, so there is nothing to be afraid of". The second disagreed: "No, that's not enough. Some of them fancy that they act for more noble motives than fear. Why not tell them there is no heaven? Take away all hope, take away a future to look forward to." The third spoke out of his experience: "Forget about this heaven and hell tactic. That is all too unreal for them. I know how they live and how they think. You must meet them where they are. Don't bother telling them there is no hell. Don't tell them there is no heaven. Just tell them there is no hurry."

Christmas Shoebox Appeal.

The closing date to ensure that boxes will reach their intended locations is **November 10th** so that children can enjoy their gifts for Christmas. We thank those who have responded, again a very generous response from our members. Thank you!

SMA Church & Parish Centre smawilton

The list of November memorial services are as follows:

Blessing of the Graves - St Finbarr's Cemetery
Sunday 8th November at 2.30 pm

A special Mass to remember all who have died in our community, especially those who have passed away during the last year.
Tuesday 10th November at 7.30 pm

Cork Stroke Association
Thursday 12th November at 11 am

Annual Mass for Deceased Members of An Garda Síochána
Thursday 12th November at 7.30 pm

Annual Remembrance Mass for members of PNT, Telecom, Eircom and Eir.
Saturday 14th November at 11 am

Wilton Bowls Mass of Remembrance
Thursday 19th November at 8pm

E.S.B. - Annual Mass in memory of Deceased Staff (Cork)
Saturday 28th November at 11 am

Féileacáin (Stillbirth & Neonatal Death Association of Ireland)
Saturday 12th December at 3 pm



November Bereavement Masses.

During the month of November, the parish will conduct the usual Masses in memory of those who died in our parish during the past year and for the various groups who use our church to remember their dead. Any group yet to confirm a date with the parish should do so this week.

Week of Witness for Persecuted Christians

15-22 November 2026

220 million Christians live in countries where they are directly exposed to persecution, while 413 million Christians live in countries where religious freedom is severely violated, that is 18%, or about one in five Christians.

Around the church and in the Parish Centre are fact sheets outlining some facts of the top countries where this persecution is real and the types of persecution being faced by Christians.

Red Wednesday 2026 will be observed on **Wednesday 18 November** 2026, as part of a global initiative by Aid to the Church in Need (ACN) to highlight the persecution of Christians and promote religious freedom.

On that day we invite people coming to church or visiting our Parish Centre to wear some red item of clothing as a gesture of solidarity with our fellow persecuted Christians around the world.

RED WEDNESDAY

Sacred Space 2026

Copies of Sacred Space 2026 for Advent and Christmas are on sale in the Mass Office. €8 a copy.